S101/1
GENERAL PAPER
Paper 1
August 2026
2 hours 40 minutes

MASAKA DIOCESAN EXAMINATIONS BOARD

Uganda Advanced Certificate of Education

JOINT MOCK EXAMINATIONS 2026

GENERAL PAPER 1

2 hours 40 minutes

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

*This paper consists of **two** sections: **A** and **B**.*

*It has **three** examination items.*

*Section **A** is **compulsory.***

*Section **B** has **two items**. Answer **only one item.***

Clearly indicate the item number at the beginning of each response.

Only the required number of items will be marked.

*Any additional **Item** attempted will **not be scored***

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SECTION A:

Item 1

Across the globe, countries are expanding rapidly. Technology is advancing and artificial intelligence is becoming part of everyday life. Today's young people are growing up in a world shaped by social media and global digital culture. While these developments have brought education, communication, and entertainment closer than ever before, they have also created a serious challenge: cultural erosion and identity confusion among the youth. Your school publication team has identified the need to address this situation using the school magazine as a platform for awareness and reflection.

Task:
As a member of this committee, write what you will present for the school magazine.

(Use 300–400 words.)

SECTION B:

Item 2

Studies in different countries show that the reading culture among young people is now at its lowest level in decades. In a 2024 literary report, only about one-third of young people can read continuously for thirty minutes at a time. The situation is not any different in your school, Nahi Boarding School. The administration is increasingly concerned about poor reading habits because they weaken the cognitive and intellectual development of learners. Their ability to read and comprehend gets negatively affected. Reasoning and creativity reduces eventually leading to poor academic performance. Therefore, the administration has requested the Senior Six class members to embark on a research study on this issue.

Task:
As a learner in this class, write a research proposal that will be used during the study.
(Use 500 – 700 words)

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Item 3

In your country, reported mental health cases have increased by more than 70% in four years, rising from about 524,000 to over 800,000 cases. The report also notes that about 23% of children are affected by mental health challenges. These challenges are negatively affecting learners' emotional well-being, concentration, academic performance and social relationships.

Many students are increasingly withdrawing from friends, avoiding interaction and isolating themselves from school and community activities. This situation is also evidenced at a local level in Dombo, your village, where there is an increasing risk of self-harm and suicidal thoughts among your fellow peers. As a result, this situation has become a serious concern for teachers, parents and community leaders, who are now calling for an urgent investigation into this issue.

Task:

As a student researcher, create a plan that you would use to carry out an investigation into this matter.

(Use 500 – 700 words)

END

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